

Day 28 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Union, States, and Union Territories

READING MATERIAL

Covers Articles 1-4 (the Union and its territory, formation of new states) and Part VIII (Union Territories). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests this via statement-combination ('which of the following are true') and match-the-following (Act name vs. year of enactment) formats specifically.

Q: What does Article 1 of the Constitution declare about India?

A: "India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States" — establishing India as an indestructible Union, not a voluntary federation that states can secede from (unlike the original US model).

Q: What was the ORIGINAL (1949) four-fold classification of states, and what replaced it?

A: Part A states (former Governor's Provinces of British India), Part B states (former princely states/unions of princely states), Part C states (centrally administered, including former Chief Commissioners' Provinces), and Part D (the Andaman & Nicobar Islands). This was abolished by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 along with the 7th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1956.

Q: Who chaired the States Reorganisation Commission, and what did it recommend vs. what was actually implemented?

A: Justice Fazal Ali chaired the Commission (members: H.N. Kunzru, K.M. Panikkar), constituted December 1953, report submitted September 1955. It recommended 16 states + 3 centrally administered territories, primarily reorganising states on a LINGUISTIC basis — but the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 that Parliament actually passed created 14 states + 6 Union Territories.

Q: What do Articles 2, 3, and 4 empower Parliament to do?

A: Article 2: admit into the Union, or establish, new states. Article 3: form new states by separation/uniting territory from existing states, alter boundaries, or change names of existing states. Article 4: laws made under Articles 2/3 can amend the First Schedule (list of states/UTs) and Fourth Schedule (Rajya Sabha seat allocation) without being treated as a formal Constitutional Amendment.

Q: Is a law under Article 3 (altering state boundaries/names) passed as an ordinary law or a Constitutional Amendment, and what is the procedure?

A: As an ORDINARY law, by simple majority — NOT a Constitutional Amendment under Article 368. However, the Bill must first be referred by the President to the affected State Legislature(s) for their views (not their consent — Parliament can override their views) within a specified time, before introduction.

Q: How are Union Territories administered, per Part VIII of the Constitution?

A: Under Article 239, every Union Territory is administered by the President, acting through an Administrator appointed by him/her (titled Lieutenant Governor in some UTs). Some UTs (e.g. Puducherry, and Delhi specially) have been given their own Legislative Assembly and Council of Ministers by separate laws — they are not all administered identically.

Q: Real exam: Does Delhi have its own High Court? Is Parliament empowered to constitute a High Court for any Union Territory?

A: Yes — Delhi DOES have its own separate High Court (the Delhi High Court, established 1966) — a real exam question that frames this as FALSE (claiming Delhi has no separate High Court) is testing recognition of that false statement. Separately, Article 241 DOES empower Parliament to constitute a High Court for any Union Territory by law — both this and the Delhi-HC fact were tested together in one real combination question.

Q: Real exam: When did Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram become full-fledged states, and which Act for Union Territories' administration governs many of the rest?

A: Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram became full-fledged states on 20 February 1987 (under the State of Arunachal Pradesh Act and the State of Mizoram Act, both 1986). Separately, the Government of Union Territories Act, 1963 provides for Legislative Assemblies/Councils of Ministers in certain Union Territories.

Q: Real exam: Match these enacted years to their Acts — 1963, 1991, 1971, 1951.

A: 1963 → Government of Union Territories Act. 1991 → Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi Act (gave Delhi its special Article 239AA legislative status). 1971 → Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act. 1951 → Representation of the People Act (note: there are two — the 1950 Act on delimitation/voter qualification, and the 1951 Act on conduct of elections; the exam's pairing uses 1951).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Article 1 of the Constitution declares that India, that is Bharat, shall be a:

A. Federation of States

B. Union of States ✓

C. Confederation

D. Republic of independent states

Explanation: Union of States. [easy, authored]

2. The States Reorganisation Commission (1953-55) was chaired by:

A. K.M. Panikkar

B. H.N. Kunzru

C. Fazal Ali ✓

D. B.G. Kher

Explanation: Justice Fazal Ali. [medium, web-research]

3. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 created how many states and Union Territories, compared to what the Commission had recommended?

A. 14 states + 6 UTs, vs. the Commission's recommended 16 states + 3 UTs ✓

B. 16 states + 3 UTs, exactly as recommended

C. 20 states + 2 UTs

D. 9 states + 10 UTs

Explanation: Act created 14 states + 6 UTs; Commission had recommended 16 states + 3 UTs. [hard, web-research]

4. Which Article empowers Parliament to alter the boundaries, area, or name of an existing State by an ordinary law (simple majority, not a Constitutional Amendment)?

A. Article 1

B. Article 2

C. Article 3 ✓

D. Article 5

Explanation: Article 3. [medium, authored]

5. Before introducing an Article 3 Bill altering a State's boundary, the President must refer it to:

A. The Supreme Court for binding consent

B. The affected State Legislature(s) for their views ✓

C. The Election Commission

D. No one — it can be introduced directly

Explanation: The affected State Legislature(s), for views (not binding consent). [medium, authored]

6. Under Part VIII of the Constitution, a Union Territory is administered by the President acting through:

A. The Chief Minister

B. An Administrator ✓

C. The Speaker of the State Legislature

D. The Chief Justice of the High Court

Explanation: An Administrator. [easy, authored]

7. Which of the following statements is/are TRUE? (i) Parliament is empowered to constitute a High Court for any Union Territory. (ii) Delhi does not have a separate High Court of its own. (iii) Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram became full-fledged states in 1987.

A. (ii) and (iii) only

B. (ii) only

C. (i) and (ii) only

D. (i) and (iii) only ✓

Explanation: (i) and (iii) are true; (ii) is false — Delhi DOES have its own High Court. [hard, question-bank-2025]

8. Match: (a) Government of Union Territories Act, (b) Government of NCT of Delhi Act, (c) Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, (d) Representation of the People Act — with years 1963, 1991, 1971, 1951 respectively. Which option correctly lists (a)(b)(c)(d) in year-order 1963/1991/1971/1951?

A. 1963, 1991, 1971, 1951 — exactly as listed ✓

B. 1951, 1971, 1991, 1963

C. 1991, 1963, 1951, 1971

D. 1971, 1951, 1963, 1991

Explanation: The Acts pair exactly with the years as listed: 1963/UT Act, 1991/GNCTD Act, 1971/National Honour Act, 1951/Representation of the People Act. [hard, question-bank-2024]

9. Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram became full-fledged states of the Indian Union on:

A. 15 August 1947

B. 26 January 1950

C. 20 February 1987 ✓

D. 1 November 1956

Explanation: 20 February 1987. [medium, question-bank-2025]

10. The Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi Act, which gave Delhi its own Legislative Assembly and Council of Ministers, was enacted in:

A. 1956

B. 1963

C. 1971

D. 1991 ✓

Explanation: 1991. [medium, question-bank-2024]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

READING MATERIAL

Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.

Q: Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

A: Chain it: $B > D > C > A$. So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

Q: Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

A: Let son's current age = x , father = $4x$. In 20 years: father = $4x+20$, son = $x+20$. Condition: $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$. Son is 10, father is 40.

Q: Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

A: His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

Q: Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

A: Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

Q: Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

A: $C=600$. $B=3 \times 600=1800$. $A=2 \times 1800=3600$. Total = $3600+1800+600 = 6000$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

Explanation: Chain: $S > Q > P > R$. S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

Explanation: Daughter= x , mother= $3x$. $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$. [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

Explanation: 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

Explanation: Let $C=x$, $B=2x$, $A=4x$. Total= $7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$. [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

A. C, A, B, D ✓

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

Explanation: C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "His First Flight" — Liam O'Flaherty

READING MATERIAL

A short story about a young seagull too afraid to fly from his cliff ledge, alone after his siblings have already flown, who is finally driven to attempt flight by hunger and his mother's coaxing — and discovers joy and confidence once he succeeds.

Q: Who wrote "His First Flight", and what is the story about?

A: Liam O'Flaherty (1896-1984), an Irish novelist and short-story writer. The story follows a young seagull, left alone on a high ledge after his two brothers and one sister have already flown off, who is too afraid to attempt his own first flight.

Q: Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?

A: He was terrified at the thought of his wings being unable to support him over the vast, far-below expanse of sea — not simply a generic fear of heights, but specifically the thought of his wings failing him mid-flight.

Q: How did the young seagull's parents try to get him to fly, and what finally triggered his first flight attempt?

A: His parents largely ignored/left him alone for a day rather than coaxing him directly. It was ultimately his MOTHER's attempt to bring him food (tempting him toward the edge) that finally prompted his first flight.

Q: What happened when the young seagull tried to land on the sea after his first flight, and how did his family react?

A: He discovered, to his relief, that he could float on the water's surface rather than sinking — a moment of fear giving way to a new, safe discovery. His family then praised him and offered him food, celebrating his success.

Q: What emotion did the young seagull feel once he successfully completed his first flight?

A: Joy — despite his initial terror, his first successful flight left him fearless, exhilarated, and confident, flapping his wings to soar with a joyous scream.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "His First Flight" is a lesson about a:

- A. Pilot
- B. Seagull ✓**
- C. Parrot
- D. Pigeon

Explanation: Seagull. [easy, question-bank-2022]

2. "His First Flight" was written by:

- A. James Grover Thurber
- B. Liam O'Flaherty ✓**
- C. Ruskin Bond
- D. Munshi Premchand

Explanation: Liam O'Flaherty. [easy, web-research]

3. Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?

- A. He had never seen anyone else fly
- B. He thought his wings would not support him ✓**
- C. He did not want to leave his ledge
- D. He was scared of other birds

Explanation: He thought his wings would not support him (fear of unsupported wings). [medium, web-research]

4. How did the young seagull's parents try to encourage him to fly?

- A. They ignored him for a day ✓**
- B. They brought him food every hour
- C. They offered him rewards
- D. They flew away and left him alone permanently

Explanation: They ignored him for a day. [medium, web-research]

5. What finally prompted the young seagull to make his first flight?

- A. His mother's attempt to bring food ✓**

- B. The sight of his siblings flying
- C. His father's scolding
- D. Fear of being left behind

Explanation: His mother's attempt to bring food. [medium, web-research]

6. What emotion did the young seagull feel after his first successful flight?

- A. Fear
- B. Confusion
- C. Joy ✓**
- D. Anger

Explanation: Joy. [easy, web-research]

7. What happened when the young seagull tried to land on the sea?

- A. He immediately drowned
- B. He found he could float on the water ✓**
- C. He got scared and flew back to the ledge
- D. He was pulled under by the current

Explanation: He found he could float on the water. [medium, web-research]

8. How did the seagull's family react to his first flight?

- A. They ignored him
- B. They scolded him for being late
- C. They praised him and offered him food ✓**
- D. They left him alone on the cliff

Explanation: They praised him and offered him food. [easy, web-research]